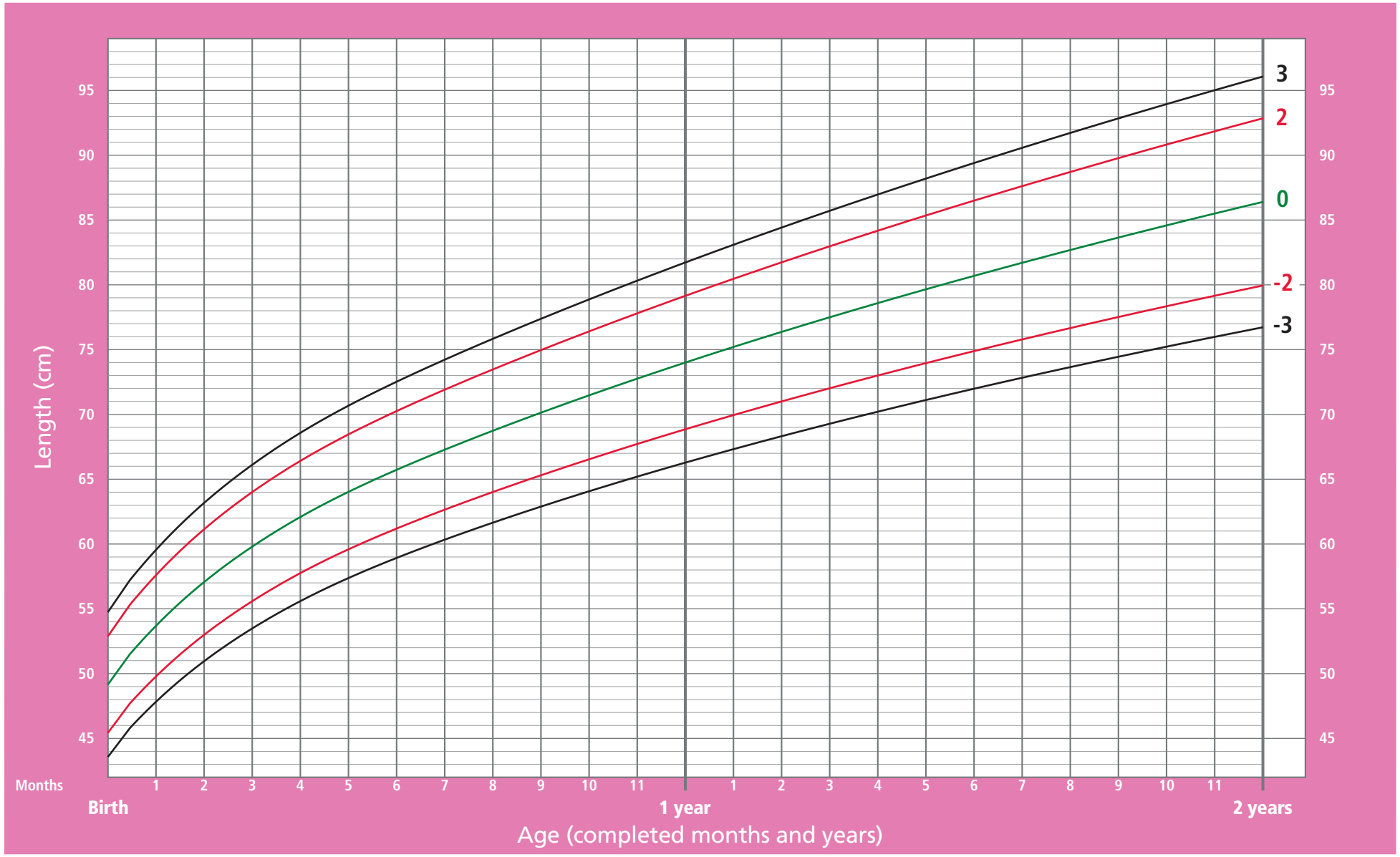
Length-for-age GIRLS

Birth to 2 years (z-scores)

World Health Organization

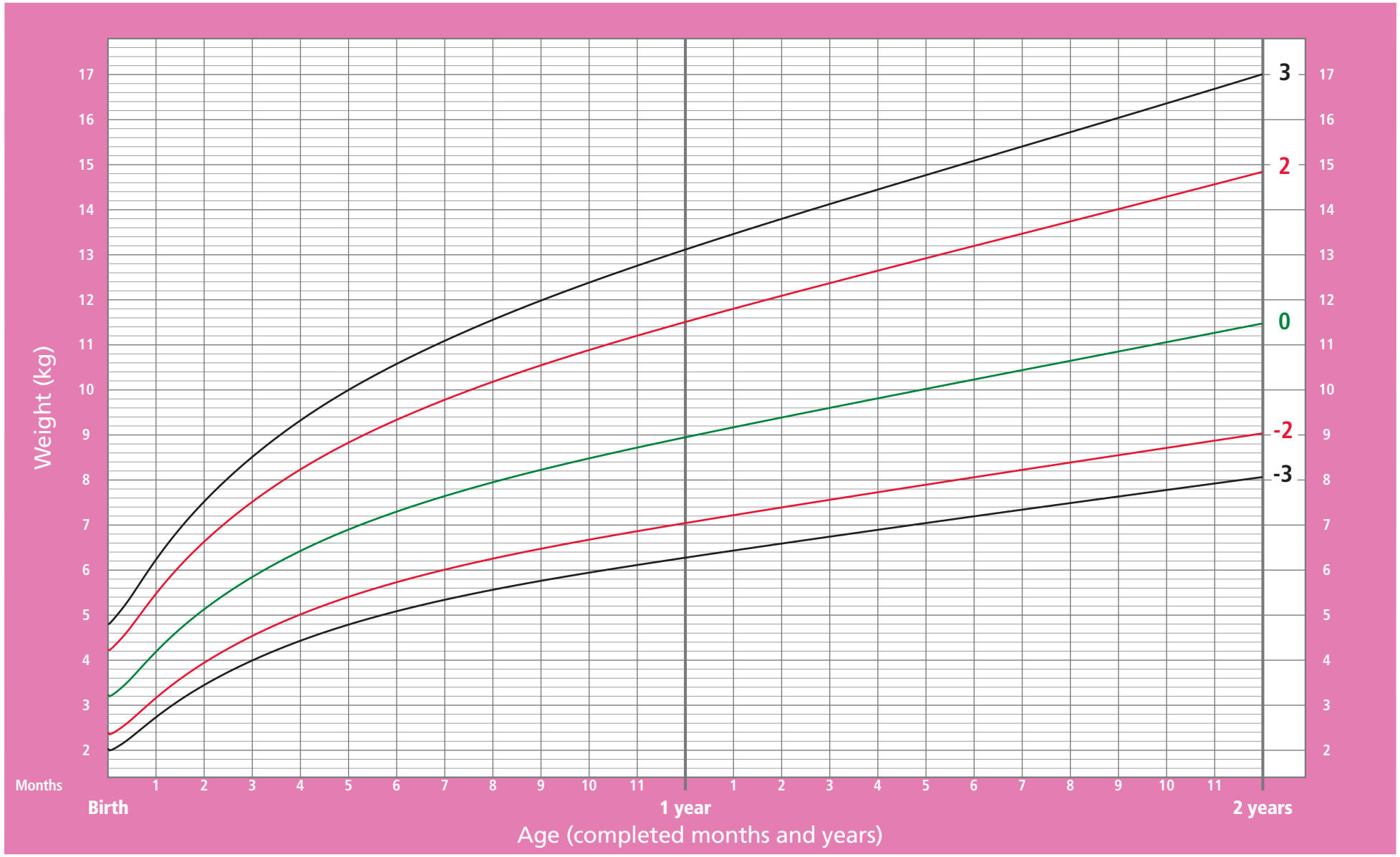


WHO Child Growth Standards

Weight-for-age GIRLS

Birth to 2 years (z-scores)

World Health Organization

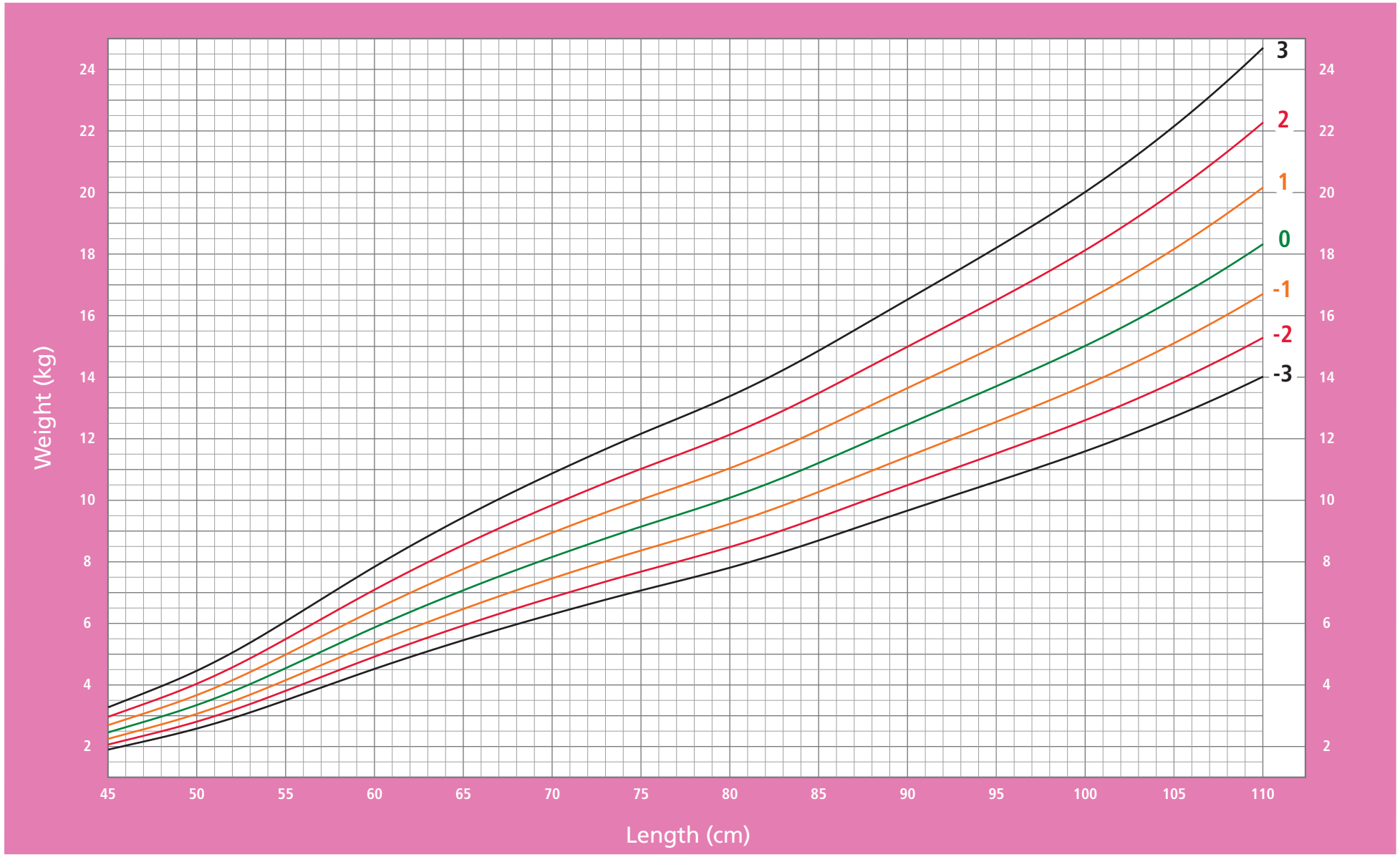


WHO Child Growth Standards

Weight-for-length GIRLS

Birth to 2 years (z-scores)

World Health Organization

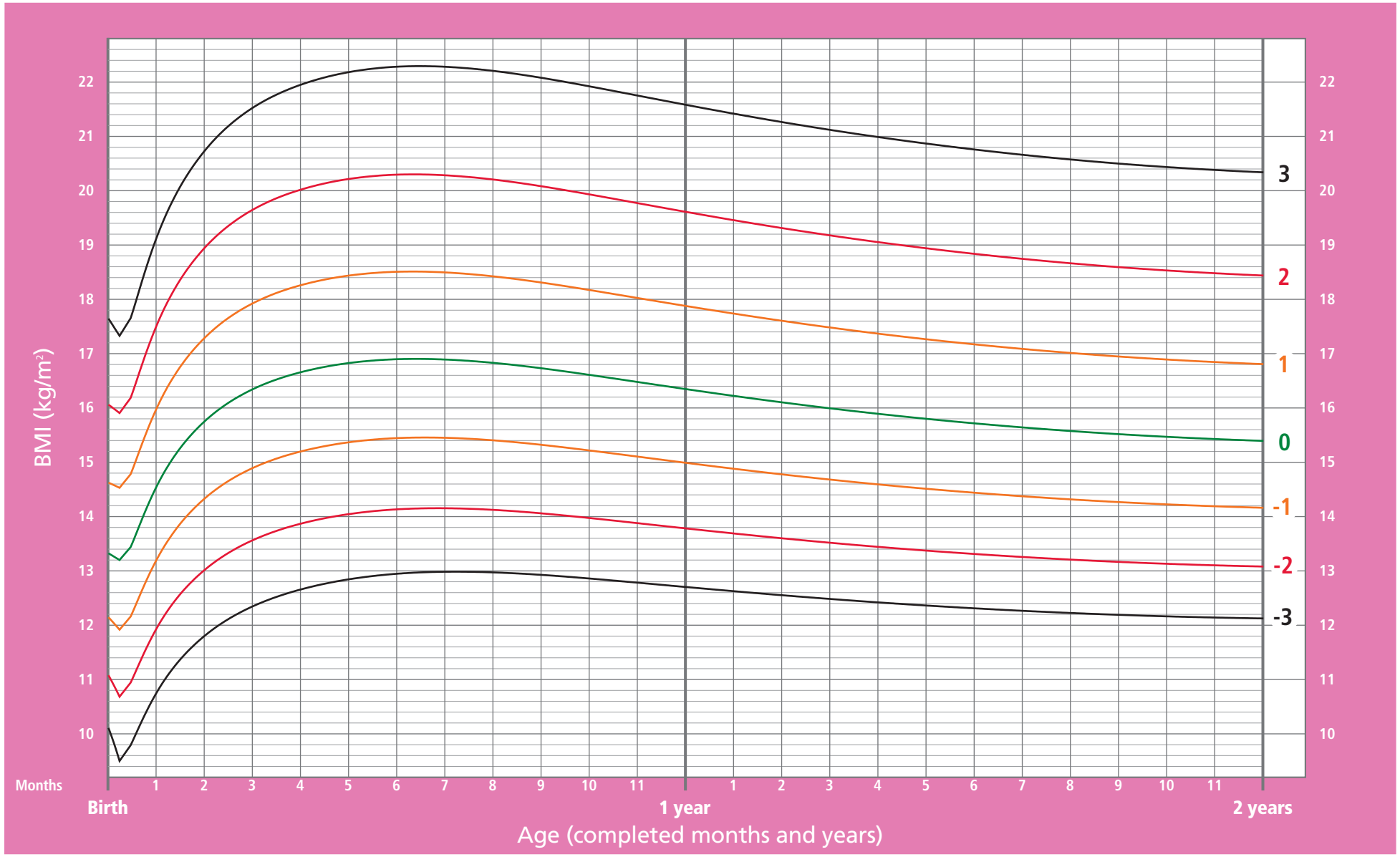


WHO Child Growth Standards

BMI-for-age GIRLS

Birth to 2 years (z-scores)

World Health Organization

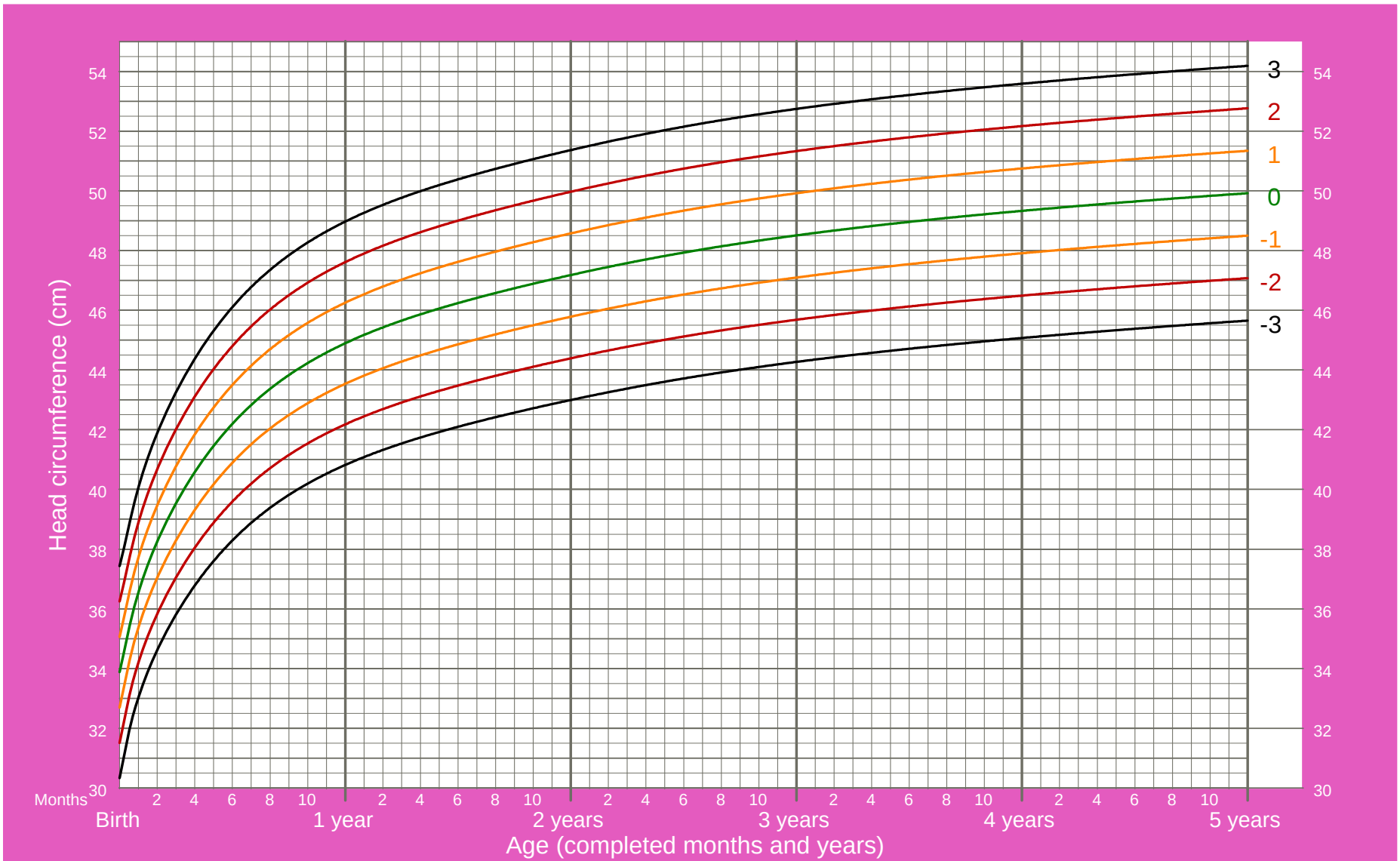


WHO Child Growth Standards

Head circumference-for-age GIRLS

Birth to 5 years (z-scores)

World Health Organization



WHO Child Growth Standards

Z-score	Growth indicators			
	Length/height - for-age	Weight-for- age	Weight-for-length/height	BMI-for-age
Above 3	See note 1	See note 2	Obese	Obese
Above 2			Overweight	Overweight
Above 1			Possible risk of overweight (See note 3)	Possible risk of overweight (See note 3)
0 (median)				
Below 1				
Below 2	Stunted (See note 4)	Underweight	Wasted	Wasted
Below 3	Severely stunted (See note 4)	Severely underweight (See note 5)	Severely wasted	Severely wasted

Notes:

1. A child in this range is very tall. Tallness is rarely a problem, unless it is so excessive that it may indicate an endocrine disorder such as a growth-hormone-producing tumor. Refer a child in this range for assessment if you suspect an endocrine disorder
2. A child whose weight-for-age falls in this range may have a growth problem, but this is better assessed from weight-for-length/height or BMI-for-age.
3. A plotted point above 1 shows possible risk. A trend towards the 2 z-score line shows definite risk.
4. It is possible for a stunted or severely stunted child to become overweight.
5. This is referred to as very low weight in IMCI training modules. (Integrated Management of Childhood Illness, In-service training. WHO, Geneva, 1997)